

STEAL The 1-Minute Strategy That Made Him \$1.8M+ (Works Every Session): Summary & Key Takeaways — Glimpse

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The 1-Minute Strategy: \$1.8M in Prop Firm Payouts

Summary of the video "STEAL The 1-Minute Strategy That Made Him \$1.8M+ (Works Every Session)" by Chart Fanatics.

JJ Simon, the world's youngest quant trader, reveals his mechanical fair pricing theory strategy that generated \$1.8M+ in prop firm payouts in 18 months. Using pure price action on 1-minute NASDAQ futures charts, he optimizes static risk-to-reward ratios for prop firm rules, trades session opens and news reversions, and manages 45+ accounts simultaneously by layering entries with a strict bias-based approach.

The Foundation: Fair Pricing Theory

What is Fair Pricing Theory

Fair pricing theory applies quantitative finance principles to identify the true equilibrium price of NASDAQ futures. It focuses only on external factors like news and session opens that create initial unfair price moves, then trades reversions back to that fair price.

Why Session Opens Create Opportunity

At 9:30 a.m. EST, overnight orders and institutional volume create an initial unfair displacement from the previous day's close. This influx creates a continuation trade opportunity, followed by reversions back to the opening price as the market finds equilibrium.

The Three Core Entry Signals

Displacement candles (body larger than previous, closes below the wick), break of structure (wick lower than two adjacent candles, then broken), and news reversions (expected news priced in, initial move unfair). All entries are mechanical with only two qualifications to check.

Mechanical Trading Rules

Static Risk-to-Reward is Optimal for Prop Firms

Prop firm environments require fixed risk and profit targets optimized for account rules, not market structure. A 1:1 or 1:1.5 ratio works best for evaluations; funded accounts use 1:4 or higher depending on consistency rules. This differs from live trading, which requires discretionary targets.

Optimize Take Profit First, Stop Loss Second

On prop firms, the take profit determines expected value and should be set based on account rules and available points to fair price. The stop loss is then set as a static reciprocal of the take profit, making it essentially random but mathematically paired to the profit target.

The Three-Loss Rule Ends the Session

If three consecutive reversion trades lose in a single session, stop trading. This signals the market is trending and fair price has moved; continuing would violate the bias. This rule prevents overtrading and preserves capital.

Trade Only the First 90 Minutes of Each Session

Focus on the first 90 minutes of New York open (9:30–11:00 a.m. EST), Asia open, and New York PM open (2:00–3:30 p.m. EST). Between 11 a.m. and 2 p.m., volume is dead; after 3:30 p.m., liquidity drops. These windows have the highest edge.

News and Expected vs. Unexpected Events

Expected News (Red Folder) is Priced In

Scheduled economic news (CPI, PPI at 8:30 a.m. EST) is forecasted and already reflected in price action over the prior 6–12 hours. The initial candle after release is unfair; trade reversions back to the pre-news price because the outcome is almost always close to forecast.

Unexpected News Changes Fair Price

Unscheduled events (tweets, Fed chair speeches) create a new fair price. After the move, consolidation becomes the new fair price. Trade continuations (slight drift) or reversions to that new consolidation, not back to the pre-news level.

News Reversions are the Strongest Trades

Expected news reversions have the highest win rate because the initial candle is unfair 100% of the time. The pre-news price is fair 99% of the time, making this the A+ setup for funded accounts.

Account Management and Scaling

Layer Evaluations Across Multiple Accounts

Each trade goes on a separate account to spread risk and maximize bias realization. Use displacement candles for evaluations (lower pass rate, faster to trade), and break of structure for funded accounts (higher win rate, stronger entry). This allows 30+ trades per session across different accounts.

Adjust Contract Size Based on Points Available

If a trade offers 76 points to fair price but the account needs only 38, cut contracts in half (e.g., 1 contract becomes 5 micros). This keeps dollar risk constant while adapting to available points, maintaining optimal expected value.

Consistency Rules Require Lower Risk-to-Reward

Accounts with 50% consistency rules force you to keep winning to reach payout targets. Use 1:1 or 1:1.5 ratios to hit the goal faster; a 1:4 ratio would take 3–6 months of daily trades to accumulate enough RR, risking drawdown oscillation.

Go Live Only When Expected Value Increases

Understand the live account rules and expected value before being moved. Keep SIM balance below the live account size to avoid losing expected value. New firms have better payout policies; start with one account, get payout, reinvest into 5 funded accounts.

The Numbers: Expected Value and Profitability

Back Test for Pass Rate, Not Equity Curve

Prop firms are designed so live account equity curves don't work. Instead, simulate 10 funded accounts with the same risk-to-reward on every trade and find your pass rate (e.g., 25% = pass 1 of 4). This is the only metric that matters for prop profitability.

Calculate Cost Per Funded Account

Divide evaluation cost (\$100) by pass rate (e.g., 25%) to get cost per funded account (\$400). If your pass rate is 25%, you pass 1 out of 4 evals. This tells you the true cost of scaling.

Expected Value Must Exceed Cost to Scale

Simulate 10 funded accounts and calculate total payouts across all of them. If expected value per funded account is \$2,000 and cost is \$400, you're profitable. Only scale if $EV > \text{cost}$.

Risk of Ruin: The 91% Loss Rate

If pass rate is 30% and payout rate is 30%, multiply them: $0.30 \times 0.30 = 0.09$ (9% chance of payout). This means 91% chance of getting nothing on a single eval. However, expected value still favors you: lose \$900 on 9 evals, win \$2,000+ on 1 payout.

Variance Requires 50+ Evaluations

A small sample (3 evals) can all lose due to variance, not strategy failure. Back test at least 50 evaluations to get a reliable pass rate estimate and ensure variance doesn't skew results.

JJ's Real Results and Timeline

From \$5K to \$1.8M in 18 Months

Started with \$5,000 from poker winnings. Month 1: \$17K profit. Month 2: \$20K. Months 3–6: \$40K, \$60K, \$80K, \$100K. Total payout: \$1.8M+. Total spent on evals: ~\$400K. Net profit: ~\$1.4M after costs.

Monthly Income Trajectory

Peak months hit \$100K+. Recent months average \$50K–\$100K due to prop firm price increases and live account transitions. New traders can hit six figures monthly initially before expected value decreases as firms move them live.

Current Goal: \$5M Net Worth and Hedge Fund

JJ has ~\$250K in funded accounts ready to withdraw. Combined with profits, he's building toward \$5M net worth to launch a hedge fund. Future strategy: optimize for live account bonuses (e.g., \$4.5K bonus on \$4.5K profit on 150K accounts) rather than pure prop firm payouts.

Common Mistakes and Psychology

Back Testing on Live Equity Curves Fails

Many traders back test a strategy on a live account equity curve, see it's profitable, then fail on prop firms. Prop firms have trailing drawdowns and consistency rules that break live-account strategies. Always back test in a prop firm simulation with multiple accounts.

Adapting Fair Price Discretionarily

The biggest struggle for traders adopting this strategy is knowing when to adjust fair price. If trades are losing, the market may be trending and fair price has moved. This requires slight discretion but should be based on data, not emotion.

Tilt is Break-Even, Not Catastrophic

Going on tilt (random trading) has break-even expected value—it just adds variance. Instead of gambling one funded account, buy 20 evals and trade them correctly. Spread the same \$2K risk across 20 accounts; worst case is a bad pass rate, not a blown account.

Live Trading Examples

Tuesday Session: News Reversions and Layering

CPI at 8:30 a.m. created a \$170-point move. JJ entered short on break of structure with 175-point take profit, then layered in more accounts on displacement candles as price reverted. Multiple entries, same bias, different accounts. Won 3 trades for \$3,200, \$1,500, and more.

Friday Session: Four for Four Wins

Continuation long on open (+\$1,200), then two reversion shorts (+\$3,200, +\$1,500), then another reversion long (+\$3,000). Total: +\$9K on four funded accounts. Two losses on additional attempts, but net positive because expected value was there.

Contract Sizing on the Fly

If a trade offers 76 points but the account needs 38, cut contracts in half (1 → 5 micros). If it offers 50 points and the account needs \$6,000 profit, use 6 contracts. Dollar risk stays optimal; contracts adjust to points available.

Notable quotes

If you can follow a bias on prop firms, you're going to make a ton of money. — JJ Simon

Optimize for your take profit first. The stop loss is going to be essentially random. — JJ Simon

There is going to exist a statistically optimal risk and take profit for every single trade you take. — JJ Simon

Action items

Back test your strategy on 50+ simulated evaluations in a prop firm environment, tracking pass rate (not equity curve).

Calculate your cost per funded account: evaluation cost ÷ pass rate. Ensure expected value of funded account exceeds this cost.

Identify your high time frame bias (6–12 hour trend) and fair price (session open or pre-news consolidation) before each 90-minute trading window.

Set static risk-to-reward ratios optimized for your account rules (1:1.5 for evals, 1:1 to 1:2 for consistency accounts, 1:3+ for non-consistency).

Implement the three-loss rule: stop trading reversions in a session after three consecutive losses; fair price has likely moved.

Layer entries across multiple accounts using displacement candles (evals) and break of structure (funded) to maximize bias realization.

Simulate live account rules and expected value before being moved; keep SIM balance below live account size to avoid losing expected value.

Trade only the first 90 minutes of each session (9:30–11 a.m., 2–3:30 p.m. EST) and skip the 11 a.m.–2 p.m. dead zone.

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